

PRINTABLE WALKTHROUGH CHECKLIST

OSHA Machine Guarding Checklist for Small Manufacturers

Walk your shop with this list. Tick items you have already handled and route the rest for correction. Total items: 33, across 6 categories, tied to 29 CFR 1910.212, 1910.215, 1910.217, and 1910.219.

Facility / site	Walked by	Date

Point of Operation Guards

29 CFR 1910.212(a)(1) and 1910.212(a)(3)(ii)

- Every machine has a guard preventing operator body parts from entering the point of operation.
- Guards are anchored, not held on by tape, zip ties, wire, or magnets.
- Guards are the correct type for the hazard (barrier, interlock, presence-sensing, or two-hand control).
- Guards are in place and functional at the moment of the walkthrough, not just at inspection time.
- Openings in the guard meet the OSHA maximum reach distances by aperture size.
- Guards themselves do not create a new hazard (pinch point, shear, projectile).

Rotating and Reciprocating Parts

29 CFR 1910.219 — Mechanical power-transmission apparatus

- All belts, pulleys, gears, chains, sprockets, shafts, and couplings within 7 feet of the floor or working level are guarded.
- Set screws, keys, bolts, and shaft ends are countersunk or covered.
- Guards fully enclose the transmission side — no top, side, or bottom access to moving parts.
- Fan blades below 7 feet have guarding with openings no larger than 1/2 inch.
- Chip-shields or barrier guards on lathes, mills, and drill presses are present and used.
- Coupling and shaft covers are in place after any recent maintenance.

Abrasive Wheels and Grinders

29 CFR 1910.215 — Abrasive wheel machinery

- Bench and pedestal grinders have a work rest adjusted within 1/8 inch of the wheel.
- Tongue guard is adjusted within 1/4 inch of the wheel.
- Wheel guards enclose at least the required arc — safety guards cover the wheel spindle end, nut, and flange projections.
- Ring test performed on new wheels before mounting.
- Wheel RPM rating equals or exceeds the machine's maximum spindle RPM (visible on the wheel and the machine).
- Flanges are matched pairs, at least 1/3 the wheel diameter, and use blotters.

Saws, Presses, and Cutters

29 CFR 1910.213, 1910.212, 1910.217

- Table saws have blade guards, spreaders (riving knives), and anti-kickback fingers installed.
- Radial arm saws return to the back of the table when released and have upper blade guards.
- Mechanical power presses have point-of-operation guarding (barrier, presence-sensing, two-hand trip, or pull-back).
- Foot pedals are guarded against accidental activation.
- Shears, brakes, and iron workers have point-of-operation guards or presence-sensing devices.
- Bandsaw blades are enclosed except at the point of operation.

Guard Integrity and Bypass Prevention

29 CFR 1910.212 — general requirements

- No guards found removed, disabled, defeated, or bypassed on the shop floor.
- Interlocked guards actually stop the hazardous motion when opened — verified, not just assumed.
- Presence-sensing devices (light curtains, mats) are functional and tested.
- Damaged, cracked, or missing guards are logged for immediate replacement.
- Any temporary guard removal for maintenance follows a documented lockout/tagout procedure.

Documentation and Training

29 CFR 1910.212 and 1910.147

- Every machine has a hazard assessment on file identifying the specific point-of-operation hazards.
- Operator training records exist for every worker running a guarded machine.
- Machine-specific lockout/tagout procedures are posted at the machine or accessible in a binder.
- Guard inspection cadence is documented (typically part of monthly safety inspection).

Supervisor sign-off

Complete after the walkthrough. Findings that could not be corrected on the spot should route to a corrective-action log with an owner and a due date.

Supervisor name	
Signature	
Date completed	
Findings routed to (corrective-action log / responsible party)	

Need a second set of eyes walking your shop? A GigLine Safety Walkthrough delivers a written citation-risk report with the specific machines, guards, and corrective actions that need attention. Visit giglinecompliance.com/services or call (336) 329-8899.

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